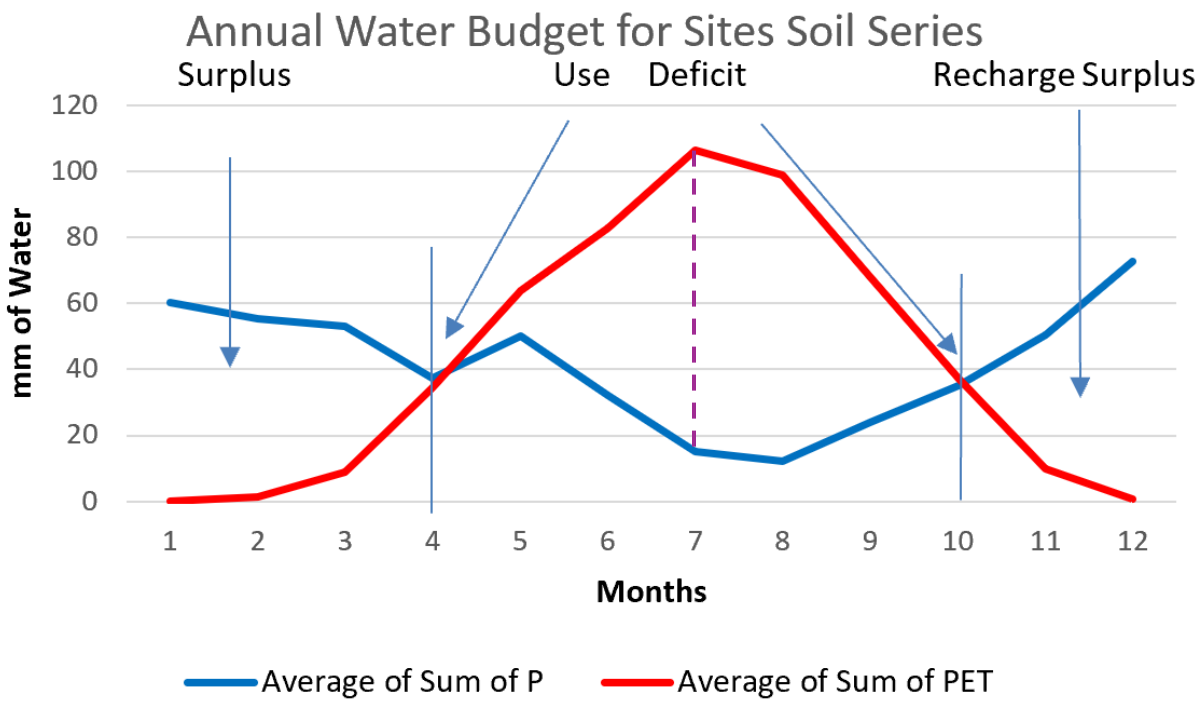
Sites H_2O Bank, and its Withdrawals

By Cody Selig October 25, 2026



This graph shows the annual water budget of the sites soil series; it includes the average evapotranspiration and precipitation for each month. With this data, you can visualize the surplus, use, deficit, and recharge. This graph can be particularly useful when trying to solve issues a drought may pose. For example, if a drought impacted this soil series, then the initial precipitation would severely decrease. This decrease would limit both the use and surplus of water within the soil. While this decrease is happening, an increase in evapotranspiration is occurring. This evapotranspiration will drain the available water storage, and this aspect of the water budget can be manipulated by management practices, whereas the lack precipitation cannot really be fixed outside of natural forces. Management practices for limiting evapotranspiration include reducing tillage in the area, increasing cover crops, and maximizing storm water runoff collection. Trying to increase water retention is the most important aspect and this can be done by reducing the sunlight that hits the soil surface while also keeping water storage below surface. For instance, “Crop residue also protects the soil surface from the sun and wind, reducing wind erosion and soil moisture losses through evaporation. In addition, residue and growing plants keep the sunlight energy off the soil surface, which reduces the soil temperature” (Jasa 2018). Which is the reason why less tillage and increase in cover crop use in

agriculture areas would be necessary for keeping the water table of this soil healthy through a disturbance such as drought.

References

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